

Absolutely — **mortgage** is a strong word-family target because your passage uses it here:

> “if an electric model stretches their **mortgage budget** ...”

Here **mortgage** refers to **a loan secured against property, usually used to finance the purchase of a home**, and by extension the household’s regular mortgage payments are already placing demands on its budget.

Word family: **mortgage / mortgaged / mortgagee / mortgagor**

Noun: mortgage

Verb: mortgage

Adjective/participle: mortgaged

Legal nouns: mortgagee, mortgagor

Major domains:

- * home/property finance
- * secured lending
- * monthly household expenditure
- * refinancing
- * interest rates
- * property security
- * figurative sacrificing of the future
- * specialist legal terminology

A major warning from the start:

- > **mortgage ≠ the house itself**
- > **mortgage ≠ simply rent**
- > **mortgage ≠ every kind of loan**

Its core concept is:

- > **a debt secured by property.**

Meaning in your passage: **mortgage = housing loan / mortgage payments — 按揭；按揭供款**

The phrase is:

- > “stretches their **mortgage budget**”

The writer is imagining a young couple who already have substantial housing costs.

Natural meaning:

> **their household budget is already constrained by mortgage payments, so paying more for an electric vehicle may make their finances uncomfortably tight.**

繁體中文：

> **按揭貸款；按揭供款；這裡指家庭在供樓壓力下可動用的財政預算**

A natural translation of the whole idea is:

> 「如果購買電動車會令他們在**供樓之餘的家庭預算**變得十分吃緊……」

Rather than literally translating **mortgage budget** as:

> 「按揭預算」

because the passage means the broader:

> **家庭財政已受到按揭供款限制。**

A. MORTGAGE — HOME/PROPERTY LOAN

1. **mortgage = loan secured against property — 按揭；抵押貸款**

The central modern meaning.

Practice 1

> “They took out a **mortgage** to buy their first home.”

「他們為購買第一個住宅而申請了**按揭貸款**。」

Practice 2

> “It may take decades to repay a mortgage.”

「償還一筆**按揭貸款**可能需要數十年。」

mortgage = 借款人以物業作擔保而取得的貸款，常用於購買住宅

B. HOME MORTGAGE

2. **home mortgage = 住宅按揭；房屋抵押貸款**

Practice 3

> “The couple applied for a home mortgage.”

「這對夫婦申請了**住宅按揭**。」

Practice 4

> “Home mortgage costs affect household spending.”

「住宅按揭成本會影響家庭開支。」

C. TAKE OUT A MORTGAGE

3. **take out a mortgage = 申請 / 取得按揭貸款**

A central construction.

Practice 5

> “They **took out a mortgage** to purchase the flat.”

「他們為購買單位而**申請了一筆按揭貸款**。」

Practice 6

> “Many buyers need to take out a mortgage.”

「很多買家都需要**申請按揭**。」

This is phrasal in form, but it is essential to the normal use of **mortgage**, so worth recognizing.

D. GET / HAVE A MORTGAGE

4. **have a mortgage = 有按揭貸款在身；正在供樓**

Practice 7

> “They already have a large mortgage.”

「他們已經有一筆很大的**按揭貸款**。」

Practice 8

> “Families with mortgages may have less disposable income.”

「正在**供樓**的家庭可支配收入可能較少。」

E. PAY A MORTGAGE

5. **pay the mortgage = 供樓；支付按揭供款**

Practice 9

> “Much of their salary goes towards paying the mortgage.”

「他們大部分薪金都用來**供樓**。」

Practice 10

> “She struggled to pay the mortgage after losing her job.”

「失業後，她很難繼續**支付按揭供款**。」

Natural Chinese often prefers:

> 供樓

rather than:

> 支付抵押貸款

in ordinary household contexts.

F. MORTGAGE PAYMENT

6. **mortgage payment = 按揭供款**

Practice 11

> “Their monthly **mortgage payment** is high.”

「他們每月的**按揭供款**很高。」

Practice 12

> “Higher interest rates can increase mortgage payments.”

「較高利率可能增加**按揭供款**。」

G. MONTHLY MORTGAGE PAYMENT

7. **monthly mortgage payment = 每月按揭供款；月供**

Practice 13

> “The monthly mortgage payment takes up much of their income.”

「每月的**供樓支出**佔去他們大部分收入。」

Practice 14

> “They calculated whether they could afford the monthly payment.”

「他們計算自己是否負擔得起每月的**按揭供款**。」

H. MORTGAGE REPAYMENT

8. **mortgage repayment = 按揭還款；供款**

Especially BrE/Hong Kong financial English.

Practice 15

> “Mortgage repayments rose after interest rates increased.”

「利率上升後，**按揭還款**增加了。」

Practice 16

> “The family spends a third of its income on mortgage repayments.”

「這個家庭把三分之一收入用於**按揭供款**。」

I. REPAY A MORTGAGE

9. **repay a mortgage = 償還按揭貸款**

Practice 17

> “They hope to repay the mortgage early.”

「他們希望提早**還清按揭**。」

Practice 18

> “The loan will be repaid over twenty years.”

「這筆按揭貸款會在二十年內**償還**。」

J. PAY OFF A MORTGAGE

10. **pay off a mortgage = 還清按揭**

Highly useful construction.

Practice 19

> “They finally paid off their mortgage.”

「他們終於**還清按揭**。」

Practice 20

> “She wants to pay off the mortgage before retirement.”

「她希望退休前**供完層樓 / 還清按揭**。」

K. MORTGAGE BALANCE

11. **mortgage balance = 按揭貸款餘額；尚欠本金**

Practice 21

> “The outstanding mortgage balance is still substantial.”

「尚欠的**按揭餘額**仍然很高。」

Practice 22

> “Each repayment reduces the mortgage balance.”

「每次還款都會減少**按揭欠款餘額**。」

L. OUTSTANDING MORTGAGE

12. **outstanding mortgage = 尚未清還的按揭貸款**

Practice 23

> “The property still has an outstanding mortgage.”

「該物業仍有一筆**未清還按揭**。」

Practice 24

> “They sold the house before the mortgage was fully repaid.”

「他們在按揭尚未完全還清前出售了房屋。」

M. MORTGAGE DEBT

13. **mortgage debt = 按揭債務**

Practice 25

> “Household mortgage debt increased.”

「家庭**按揭債務**增加了。」

Practice 26

> “Large mortgage debts can limit other spending.”

「沉重的按揭債務可能限制其他支出。」

N. MORTGAGE TERM

14. **mortgage term = 按揭年期；貸款期限**

Practice 27

> “They chose a thirty-year mortgage term.”

「他們選擇了三十年的**按揭年期**。」

Practice 28

> “A longer mortgage term can reduce monthly payments.”

「較長的按揭年期可以降低每月供款。」

But usually:

> longer term → more total interest paid

depending on loan structure.

O. MORTGAGE RATE

15. **mortgage rate = 按揭利率**

Practice 29

> “Mortgage rates have a major effect on affordability.”

「**按揭利率**對負擔能力有重大影響。」

Practice 30

> “The borrower compared mortgage rates from several lenders.”

「借款人比較了幾家貸款機構的**按揭利率**。」

P. MORTGAGE INTEREST

16. **mortgage interest = 按揭利息**

Practice 31

> “A large share of the early payments may go towards mortgage interest.”

「早期供款中可能有很大部分用於支付**按揭利息**。」

Practice 32

> “Lower interest costs can make a mortgage more affordable.”

「較低利息成本可以令按揭更容易負擔。」

Q. FIXED-RATE MORTGAGE

17. **fixed-rate mortgage = 固定利率按揭**

Practice 33

> “They chose a fixed-rate mortgage.”

「他們選擇了**固定利率按揭**。」

Practice 34

> “The interest rate remains fixed for the agreed period.”

「利率在約定期間內維持固定。」

R. VARIABLE-RATE MORTGAGE

18. **variable-rate mortgage = 浮息按揭；浮動利率按揭**

Practice 35

> “Payments on a variable-rate mortgage can change.”

「**浮息按揭**的供款可能改變。」

Practice 36

> “Borrowers face more interest-rate uncertainty with variable rates.”

「採用浮動利率的借款人面對較高的利率不確定性。」

S. ADJUSTABLE-RATE MORTGAGE

19. **adjustable-rate mortgage = 可調整利率按揭**

Especially AmE.

Common abbreviation:

> ARM

Practice 37

> “The borrower selected an adjustable-rate mortgage.”

「借款人選擇了**可調整利率按揭**。」

Practice 38

> “The rate may change according to the loan terms.”

「利率可能按照貸款條款調整。」

Broadly related to variable-rate mortgages, though product structures differ.

T. INTEREST-ONLY MORTGAGE

20. **interest-only mortgage = 只供利息按揭；只付息按揭**

Practice 39

> “For part of the term, the borrower pays only interest.”

「在部分貸款期內，借款人只支付**利息**。」

Practice 40

> “The principal still needs to be repaid later.”

「本金日後仍然需要償還。」

Specialist but common financial term.

U. REPAYMENT MORTGAGE

21. **repayment mortgage = 還本付息按揭**

Especially BrE.

Practice 41

> “Each payment reduces both interest and principal.”

「每期供款都會支付利息並逐步償還**本金**。」

Practice 42

> “A repayment mortgage is designed to clear the debt by the end of the term.”

「還本付息按揭旨在於貸款期結束時還清債務。」

V. PRINCIPAL

22. **mortgage principal = 按揭本金**

Closely related term.

Practice 43

> “Part of each payment goes towards the principal.”

「每期供款有一部分用於償還**本金**。」

Practice 44

> “The principal decreases as the loan is repaid.”

「隨着貸款逐步償還，本金會下降。」

W. DOWN PAYMENT / DEPOSIT

23. **down payment / deposit = 首期；首付款**

Not a meaning of mortgage, but essential distinction.

Practice 45

> “They saved for the down payment before applying for a mortgage.”

「申請按揭前，他們先儲錢支付**首期**。」

Practice 46

> “A larger deposit reduces the amount that needs to be borrowed.”

「較大的首期可以減少需要借入的按揭金額。」

X. MORTGAGE LENDER

24. **mortgage lender = 按揭貸款機構；貸款人**

Practice 47

> “The lender approved the mortgage.”

「貸款機構批准了這筆**按揭貸款**。」

Practice 48

> “Different mortgage lenders offer different rates.”

「不同按揭貸款機構提供不同利率。」

Y. MORTGAGE BORROWER

25. **mortgage borrower = 按揭借款人**

Practice 49

> “Borrowers must make regular payments.”

「按揭**借款人**必須定期供款。」

Practice 50

> “The borrower remains responsible for the debt.”

「借款人仍須對債務負責。」

Z. MORTGAGE APPLICATION

26. **mortgage application = 按揭申請**

Practice 51

> “Their mortgage application was approved.”

「他們的**按揭申請**獲批准。」

Practice 52

> “The lender requested additional documents.”

「貸款機構要求提供更多文件。」

AA. MORTGAGE APPROVAL

27. **mortgage approval = 按揭批核**

Practice 53

> “They waited for mortgage approval before signing the contract.”

「他們等到**按揭批核**後才簽合約。」

Practice 54

> “Approval depends on income, debt and other factors.”

「批核取決於收入、債務等因素。」

AB. MORTGAGE AFFORDABILITY

28. **mortgage affordability = 按揭負擔能力；供樓能力**

Practice 55

> “Higher rates reduce mortgage affordability.”

「較高利率會降低**按揭負擔能力**。」

Practice 56

> “The bank assessed the couple’s mortgage affordability.”

「銀行評估了這對夫婦的**供樓能力**。」

Very relevant to your source.

AC. MORTGAGE STRESS

29. **mortgage stress = 按揭供款壓力；供樓壓力**

A common economic/media expression, though exact definitions vary.

Practice 57

> “Higher rates can push households into mortgage stress.”

「較高利率可能令家庭陷入**供樓壓力**。」

Practice 58

> “Mortgage stress can reduce spending on other goods.”

「供樓壓力可能令家庭減少其他消費。」

Do not assume one universal numerical definition; different studies use different thresholds.

AD. MORTGAGE ARREARS

30. **mortgage arrears = 按揭欠供；逾期供款**

Practice 59

> “The borrower fell into mortgage arrears.”

「借款人開始出現**按揭欠供**。」

Practice 60

> “Several payments were overdue.”

「有幾期供款已經逾期。」

AE. DEFAULT ON A MORTGAGE

31. **mortgage default = 按揭違約**

Practice 61

> “Failure to make required payments may lead to mortgage default.”

「未有按要求供款可能造成**按揭違約**。」

Practice 62

> “Default can have serious financial consequences.”

「違約可能造成嚴重財務後果。」

AF. MORTGAGE DELINQUENCY

32. **mortgage delinquency = 按揭逾期還款**

Especially AmE/financial statistics.

Practice 63

> “Mortgage delinquency rates increased.”

「**按揭逾期率**上升。」

Practice 64

> “A delinquent mortgage has missed required payments.”

「逾期按揭是指未有按時支付所需供款。」

AG. FORECLOSURE

33. **mortgage foreclosure = 按揭止贖；法拍程序**

Especially AmE/legal.

Practice 65

> “Repeated default can eventually lead to foreclosure.”

「持續違約最終可能導致**止贖 / 法拍程序**。」

Practice 66

> “The lender may seek to recover the secured property.”

「貸款人可能尋求依法處置抵押物業。」

Exact legal process varies by jurisdiction.

AH. REPOSSESSION

34. **repossession = 收樓；收回抵押物業**

More common terminology in some BrE/Commonwealth contexts.

Practice 67

> “The family faced repossession after falling far behind on payments.”

「家庭在嚴重欠供後面臨**被收樓**。」

Practice 68

> “Repossession is normally a serious last-stage consequence of default.”

「收回抵押物業通常是違約後非常嚴重的後期結果。」

AI. REFINANCE A MORTGAGE

35. **refinance a mortgage = 按揭再融資；轉按**

Practice 69

> “They refinanced the mortgage at a lower interest rate.”

「他們以較低利率為按揭**再融資 / 轉按**。」

Practice 70

> “Refinancing can change the loan term or monthly payment.”

「轉按可以改變貸款年期或每月供款。」

AJ. REMORTGAGE

36. **remortgage = 重新安排按揭；轉按**

Especially BrE.

Practice 71

> “The owners decided to remortgage the property.”

「業主決定為物業**轉按**。」

Practice 72

> “They remortgaged to obtain a better rate.”

「他們為取得較佳利率而**重新安排按揭**。」

AK. SECOND MORTGAGE

37. **second mortgage = 第二按揭；二按**

Practice 73

> “They took a second mortgage on the property.”

「他們以該物業申請了**第二按揭**。」

Practice 74

> “A second mortgage is subordinate to the first mortgage.”

「第二按揭的受償順位通常低於第一按揭。」

Legal details vary.

AL. FIRST MORTGAGE

38. **first mortgage = 第一按揭；第一順位抵押**

Practice 75

> “The bank holds the first mortgage.”

「銀行持有該物業的**第一按揭 / 第一順位抵押權**。」

Practice 76

> “Priority matters if the property is sold after default.”

「如違約後出售物業，債權順位十分重要。」

AM. REVERSE MORTGAGE

39. **reverse mortgage = 逆按揭**

Practice 77

> “A reverse mortgage allows eligible homeowners to access part of their home equity.”

「**逆按揭**讓合資格業主把部分物業資產價值轉化為資金。」

Practice 78

> “The loan structure differs from an ordinary home mortgage.”

「這種貸款結構與一般住宅按揭不同。」

A distinct financial product.

AN. COMMERCIAL MORTGAGE

40. **commercial mortgage = 商業物業按揭**

Practice 79

> “The company obtained a commercial mortgage to buy an office.”

「公司取得**商業物業按揭**購買辦公室。」

Practice 80

> “Commercial mortgage terms may differ from residential lending.”

「商業物業按揭的條款可能與住宅按揭不同。」

AO. RESIDENTIAL MORTGAGE

41. **residential mortgage = 住宅按揭**

Practice 81

> “Residential mortgages finance homes rather than commercial property.”

「住宅按揭用於融資購買住宅，而非商業物業。」

Practice 82

> “The bank has a large residential mortgage portfolio.”

「銀行擁有龐大的**住宅按揭貸款組合**。」

AP. MORTGAGE PORTFOLIO

42. **mortgage portfolio = 按揭貸款組合**

Banking.

Practice 83

> “The bank reviewed its mortgage portfolio.”

「銀行檢討其**按揭貸款組合**。」

Practice 84

> “A mortgage portfolio contains many individual mortgage loans.”

「按揭貸款組合由很多個別按揭貸款構成。」

AQ. MORTGAGE-BACKED SECURITY

43. **mortgage-backed security = 按揭抵押證券**

Finance.

Common abbreviation:

> MBS

Practice 85

> “Mortgage-backed securities are linked to pools of mortgage loans.”

「**按揭抵押證券**與一組按揭貸款的現金流相關。」

Practice 86

> “Investors buy and sell mortgage-backed securities.”

「投資者會買賣按揭抵押證券。」

Specialist but important family extension.

AR. MORTGAGE BOND

44. **mortgage bond = 按揭債券 / 以資產抵押的債券**

Meaning and legal structure vary by system.

Practice 87

> “The bond is secured by specified property assets.”

「該債券由指定物業資產作擔保。」

Practice 88

> “The precise meaning depends on the financial jurisdiction.”

「具體含義取決於相關金融制度。」

Lower priority.

AS. MORTGAGE AS VERB

45. **mortgage property = 把物業抵押以借款**

A major separate grammatical use.

Practice 89

> “They **mortgaged their house** to raise money.”

「他們把房屋**抵押**以籌集資金。」

Practice 90

> “The property had already been mortgaged to the bank.”

「該物業已經**抵押給銀行**。」

mortgage — verb = 以物業作為貸款擔保

AT. MORTGAGED PROPERTY

46. **mortgaged property = 已抵押物業**

Practice 91

> “The bank has a security interest in the mortgaged property.”

「銀行對**已抵押物業**享有擔保權益。」

Practice 92

> “The owner may still live in and use the mortgaged home.”

「業主仍然可以居住和使用**已按揭的住宅**。」

Important:

> mortgaged does not mean the bank automatically owns the home.

AU. HEAVILY MORTGAGED

47. **heavily mortgaged = 按揭負擔很重的；抵押借款比例高的**

Practice 93

> “The household is heavily mortgaged.”

「這個家庭的**按揭債務負擔很重**。」

Practice 94

> “A heavily mortgaged property leaves the owner with less equity.”

「按揭貸款比例很高的物業會令業主剩下較少淨值。」

AV. MORTGAGE SOMETHING FIGURATIVELY

48. **mortgage the future = 透支 / 犧牲未來以換取現在利益**

A major figurative extension.

Practice 95

> “Borrowing excessively can **mortgage the future**.”

「過度借貸可能會**透支未來**。」

Practice 96

> “Short-term gains should not be achieved by mortgaging future generations.”

「不應透過**犧牲後代未來利益**來換取短期收益。」

mortgage the future = 用未來的自由、資源或利益作代價，換取眼前利益

This is genuine figurative polysemy.

AW. MORTGAGE FUTURE INCOME / PROSPECTS

49. **mortgage future income/prospects = 以未來收入 / 前景作代價換取現在利益**

Practice 97

> “The company mortgaged its future earnings to survive.”

「公司等於**透支未來盈利**來維持生存。」

Practice 98

> “Heavy debt can mortgage a young household’s future.”

「沉重債務可能會**綁住 / 透支年輕家庭的未來**。」

Figurative and formal.

AX. MORTGAGEE

50. **mortgagee = 按揭權人；接受抵押的一方；通常是貸款人**

Legal term.

Practice 99

> “The bank is the **mortgagee**.”

「銀行是**按揭權人 / 承按人**。」

Practice 100

> “The mortgagee holds security rights over the property.”

「按揭權人對物業享有擔保權利。」

Critical trap:

> **mortgagee** = lender, not borrower.

The **-ee** ending can mislead learners.

AY. MORTGAGOR / MORTGAGER

51. **mortgagor** = 抵押人；按揭借款人

Legal term.

Practice 101

> “The homeowner is the mortgagor.”

「業主是**抵押人** / 按揭借款人。」

Practice 102

> “The mortgagor agrees to use the property as security.”

「抵押人同意以物業作貸款擔保。」

Spelling:

> **mortgagor** is standard legal spelling.

AZ. MORTGAGEE VS MORTGAGOR

52. **mortgagee** vs **mortgagor**

This is high-value legal vocabulary:

mortgagee

= party receiving mortgage/security

= usually lender
= **按揭權人 / 承按人**

mortgagor

= party giving mortgage/security
= usually borrower/property owner
= **抵押人 / 按揭人**

Example:

> borrower/mortgagor → grants mortgage → lender/mortgagee

Do not reverse them.

BA. MORTGAGE BROKER

53. **mortgage broker = 按揭經紀**

Practice 103

> “The couple consulted a mortgage broker.”

「這對夫婦諮詢了**按揭經紀**。」

Practice 104

> “A broker may help borrowers compare loan products.”

「按揭經紀可協助借款人比較貸款產品。」

BB. MORTGAGE ADVISER

54. **mortgage adviser = 按揭顧問**

Practice 105

> “The adviser explained the repayment options.”

「按揭顧問解釋不同還款選擇。」

Practice 106

> “Professional roles and regulation vary by jurisdiction.”

「相關專業角色與監管制度因地區而異。」

BC. MORTGAGE BANK

55. **mortgage bank / mortgage lender = 按揭貸款機構**

The exact institutional meaning varies, so **mortgage lender** is safer for general English.

BD. MORTGAGE INSURANCE

56. **mortgage insurance = 按揭保險**

Important distinction from home insurance.

Practice 107

> “The loan may require mortgage insurance.”

「這筆貸款可能要求購買**按揭保險**。」

Practice 108

> “Mortgage insurance generally protects the lender against specified borrower-default risk.”

「按揭保險一般針對指定的借款人違約風險，為**貸款機構提供保障**。」

Important:

Mortgage insurance may primarily protect:

> lender

not the homeowner’s house itself.

BE. HOME INSURANCE VS MORTGAGE INSURANCE

57. **home insurance vs mortgage insurance**

home insurance

= protects home/property against specified damage/loss.

mortgage insurance

= typically protects lender against certain mortgage default losses.

So:

> home insurance → 物業風險

> mortgage insurance → 按揭信貸風險

Do not confuse them.

BF. LIFE INSURANCE VS MORTGAGE PROTECTION INSURANCE

58. **mortgage protection insurance = 按揭保障保險**

A product intended to help cover mortgage obligations under specified events, depending on policy.

Different from:

> mortgage insurance protecting lender against default.

Product names vary significantly by market, so read the actual policy terms.

BG. MORTGAGE VS LOAN

59. **mortgage vs loan**

loan

= any arrangement where money is borrowed and repaid.

mortgage

= loan/security arrangement specifically tied to real property.

Therefore:

- > every ordinary home mortgage involves borrowing
- > but not every loan is a mortgage.

Examples:

- * personal loan $\neq$ mortgage
- * car loan $\neq$ mortgage
- * home mortgage = secured against property

BH. MORTGAGE VS RENT

60. **mortgage vs rent**

mortgage payment

= repayment on debt used to finance property ownership.

rent

= payment for temporary right to occupy/use someone else's property.

A renter:

- > normally does not acquire ownership through rent.

A mortgage borrower:

- > is financing an ownership interest, subject to the legal structure.

BI. MORTGAGE VS DEPOSIT

mortgage

= borrowed amount/debt.

deposit/down payment

= buyer's own initial contribution.

Example:

House price:

> \$5 million

Deposit:

> \$1 million

Mortgage:

> \$4 million

Different concepts.

BJ. MORTGAGE VS HOUSE PRICE

house price

= total market/purchase price.

mortgage

= amount financed by secured borrowing.

You do not necessarily borrow:

> 100% of the house price.

BK. MORTGAGE VS MONTHLY PAYMENT

mortgage

= debt/loan arrangement.

mortgage payment

= periodic amount paid toward that debt.

So:

> "My mortgage is \$3 million."

> usually refers to loan amount/balance.

> “My mortgage payment is \$15,000 a month.”
> refers to monthly repayment.

BL. MORTGAGE VS INTEREST

mortgage

= loan.

interest

= borrowing cost.

A payment may contain:

- * principal
- * interest

These are not interchangeable.

BM. MORTGAGE VS LIEN / CHARGE

You curated **charge**.

mortgage

= specific secured property-financing/legal arrangement.

charge/lien

= broader security interest/claim against property or assets.

Legal definitions vary greatly by jurisdiction.

So:

> not every charge/lien is a mortgage.

BN. MORTGAGE VS COLLATERAL

61. **mortgage vs collateral**

mortgage

= secured loan/security arrangement.

collateral

= asset pledged as security.

In a home mortgage:

> house/property = collateral/security

> mortgage = financing/security arrangement.

BO. MORTGAGE VS SECURITY

security

in lending:

= asset/right supporting repayment.

mortgage

= particular form of security over real property plus associated loan usage.

“Security” is broader.

BP. MORTGAGE VS EQUITY

62. **mortgage vs home equity**

mortgage balance

= debt still owed.

home equity

= owner's value in property after subtracting secured debt, broadly speaking.

Simplified:

> property value – mortgage debt $\approx$ owner's equity

Example:

* home value \$5m

* mortgage \$3m

* equity $\approx$ \$2m

ignoring other claims/costs.

BQ. HOME EQUITY

63. **home equity = 房屋淨值；物業淨值**

Practice 109

> “Repaying the mortgage can increase the owner's equity.”

「償還按揭可以增加業主的**物業淨值**。」

Practice 110

> “A fall in property prices can reduce home equity.”

「樓價下跌可能降低**房屋淨值**。」

BR. NEGATIVE EQUITY

64. **negative equity = 負資產**

A major mortgage/property concept.

Practice 111

> “The homeowner fell into negative equity after prices dropped.”

「樓價下跌後，業主陷入**負資產**。」

Practice 112

> “Negative equity means the secured debt exceeds the property's value.”

「負資產大致指相關按揭債務高於物業價值。」

BS. LOAN-TO-VALUE RATIO

65. **loan-to-value ratio = 按揭成數；貸款價值比**

Common abbreviation:

> LTV

Practice 113

> “A lower loan-to-value ratio means the borrower has contributed more equity.”

「較低的貸款價值比通常表示借款人投入較多自有資金。」

Practice 114

> “Mortgage terms can depend on the LTV ratio.”

「按揭條款可能取決於**按揭成數**。」

Important property-finance concept.

BT. MORTGAGE AFFORDABILITY VS CAR AFFORDABILITY

This connects directly to your passage.

A household may separately be able to afford:

* its mortgage

* a car

but the combination can:

> stretch the overall household budget.

So:

> mortgage affordability

> ≠ car affordability

and:

> being approved for a mortgage does not mean unlimited capacity for other debt.

BU. MORTGAGE BUDGET — SOURCE-SPECIFIC

The passage's phrase:

> “stretches their mortgage budget”

is not a highly fixed financial term like:

* mortgage rate

* mortgage term

* mortgage payment

It is contextual writing.

The intended meaning is approximately:

> **the household budget already committed to, or constrained by, mortgage payments**

For MCQ purposes, I would **not** create a dictionary entry:

> mortgage budget = 按揭預算

Instead parse it compositionally:

> mortgage → 按揭 / 供樓

> budget → 家庭可用預算

> stretch their mortgage budget → 令正在供樓的家庭財政變得吃緊

That is much more precise.

BV. MORTGAGE AS “SECURITY” VS “LOAN”

A technical nuance:

In everyday English:

> “I have a mortgage.”

normally means:

> I have a housing/property loan.

In strict legal contexts, **mortgage** can focus on:

> the security interest/property arrangement securing repayment
rather than simply the money borrowed.

For general learners, the practical gloss:

> **以物業作抵押的貸款 / 按揭**

covers both safely.

BW. MORTGAGE VERB VS PLEDGE

66. **mortgage vs pledge**

mortgage property

= use real property as security for debt.

pledge asset

= give an asset/right as security more broadly.

Pledge is broader and not limited to land/property.

BX. MORTGAGE VS PAWN

mortgage

= normally property-secured formal lending, usually long-term.

pawn

= give movable personal property to a pawnbroker as security for a short-term loan.

> mortgage a house

> pawn a watch

Very different.

BY. MORTGAGE VS FINANCE

finance a home

= arrange/provide money for purchase.

mortgage a home

can mean:

= use the home as security for borrowing.

Finance is broader.

BZ. MORTGAGE VS REFINANCE

mortgage

= existing/new secured loan.

refinance

= replace/restructure existing financing with new financing.

A person can refinance:

> a mortgage.

CA. MORTGAGE VS REMORTGAGE

refinance a mortgage

= broad international/AmE wording.

remortgage

= especially BrE, arrange a new mortgage on property, often replacing previous loan.

Very close in many practical contexts.

CB. MORTGAGE VS FORECLOSURE

mortgage

= financing/security arrangement.

foreclosure

= legal enforcement process following serious default in certain jurisdictions.

You do not “have a foreclosure” merely because you have a mortgage.

CC. MORTGAGE VS REPOSSESSION

mortgage

= loan/security relationship.

repossession

= lender takes/reclaims secured property through applicable process after default.

Distinct stages/concepts.

CD. MORTGAGE VS DEBT

debt

= any money owed.

mortgage debt

= debt secured by real property.

Mortgage is one type of debt.

CE. MORTGAGE VS CREDIT

credit

= broad ability/arrangement to borrow now and repay later.

mortgage

= specific property-secured credit product.

CF. MORTGAGE VS RENTAL DEPOSIT

A rental deposit:

> protects landlord against specified tenancy losses.

A mortgage deposit/down payment:

> buyer's initial contribution to property purchase.

Same word **deposit**, very different contexts.

CG. MORTGAGEE / MORTGAGOR MEMORY TRAP

This pair deserves special attention because morphology is counterintuitive.

You might expect:

> -er/-or = giver

> -ee = receiver

That actually helps here:

mortgagor

> gives/grants mortgage/security

> borrower/property owner

mortgagee

> receives mortgage/security

> lender

So:

> **mortgagor → borrower**

> **mortgagee → lender**

CH. MORTGAGE THE FUTURE VS BORROW

67. **mortgage the future vs borrow**

borrow

= obtain something now with obligation to repay.

mortgage the future

= figuratively sacrifice future freedom/resources for present benefit.

Example:

> “We borrowed money.”

> neutral factual.

> “We mortgaged our future.”

> strong negative figurative evaluation.

CI. “MORTGAGE THE FUTURE” VS “INVEST IN THE FUTURE”

These are almost conceptual opposites:

mortgage the future

= sacrifice future interests for today.

invest in the future

= sacrifice resources today to improve future prospects.

Excellent figurative contrast.

CJ. MORTGAGE + PROPERTY OWNERSHIP

A common misconception:

> “The bank owns my house because I have a mortgage.”

That is not generally the ordinary meaning of **mortgage**.

The borrower usually has an ownership interest in the property while the lender has:

> security rights

whose exact form depends on local law.

So for vocabulary purposes:

> mortgage = secured debt

> not:

> bank ownership of house.

CK. MORTGAGE + INSURANCE

You just curated **insurance**, and these interact:

mortgage

= loan against property

mortgage insurance

= insurance related to default risk

home/property insurance

= insurance against specified property damage

Three separate concepts.

CL. MORTGAGE + INTEREST

Your Passage 3 later includes:

> “low-interest green loans”

So useful comparison:

mortgage

= type of secured loan

interest

= price/cost of borrowing that loan

A mortgage can have:

- * high interest
- * low interest
- * fixed interest
- * variable interest

CM. MORTGAGE + LOAN

Passage connection:

- > green loan
- > and
- > mortgage

Both are loans, but:

mortgage

= secured against real property

green loan

= defined by financing purpose/eligibility, not necessarily property security

So they classify lending in different ways.

CN. MORTGAGE + BUDGET + STRETCH

Your passage combines three semantic concepts:

mortgage

> existing housing debt/repayment burden

budget

> limited amount household can spend

stretch

> push those limited finances close to the limit

Therefore:

> “the EV stretches their mortgage budget”

≈

> **「買電動車會令本來已受供樓支出限制的家庭財政更加吃緊。」**

This is the best conceptual interpretation.

CO. CORE SEMANTIC MAP

The core meaning is:

> **property given as security for borrowed money**

Modern branches:

ordinary household finance

> mortgage = home loan

verb

> mortgage your house = 把房屋抵押借款

legal roles

> mortgagee / mortgagor

banking

> mortgage portfolio

securities

> mortgage-backed security

figurative

> mortgage the future = 犧牲未來換取現在利益

The figurative branch works because a literal mortgage:

> commits an asset to secure present borrowing.

Metaphorically:

> the future itself becomes the asset being committed.

CP. PRONUNCIATION & SPELLING

mortgage /'mɔ:ɡɪdʒ/ BrE

AmE commonly /'mɔ:rgɪdʒ/

Important spelling trap:

> **mortgage**

The **ʃ** is silent.

Not:

> /'mɔ:rtgeɪdʒ/ ❌

Pronunciation is approximately:

> **MOR-gij**

Forms:

> mortgage

> mortgages

> mortgaged

> mortgaging

For the verb:

> mortgage → mortgaged → mortgaging

CQ. FAMILY-EXTENSION SWEEP

Useful modern inventory:

- * **mortgage — noun** = 按揭；物業抵押貸款
- * **home mortgage** = 住宅按揭
- * **have a mortgage** = 有按揭在身 / 正在供樓
- * **take out a mortgage** = 申請按揭
- * **mortgage payment** = 按揭供款
- * **mortgage repayment** = 按揭還款
- * **mortgage balance** = 按揭餘額
- * **mortgage debt** = 按揭債務
- * **mortgage term** = 按揭年期
- * **mortgage rate** = 按揭利率
- * **mortgage interest** = 按揭利息
- * **fixed-rate mortgage** = 固定利率按揭
- * **variable-rate mortgage** = 浮息按揭
- * **adjustable-rate mortgage** = 可調整利率按揭
- * **interest-only mortgage** = 只供利息按揭
- * **repayment mortgage** = 還本付息按揭
- * **mortgage principal** = 按揭本金
- * **mortgage lender** = 按揭貸款人 / 機構
- * **mortgage borrower** = 按揭借款人
- * **mortgage application** = 按揭申請
- * **mortgage approval** = 按揭批核
- * **mortgage affordability** = 按揭負擔能力
- * **mortgage stress** = 供樓壓力
- * **mortgage arrears** = 按揭欠供
- * **mortgage default** = 按揭違約
- * **refinance a mortgage** = 按揭再融資 / 轉按
- * **remortgage** = 轉按
- * **first mortgage** = 第一按揭
- * **second mortgage** = 第二按揭
- * **reverse mortgage** = 逆按揭
- * **commercial mortgage** = 商業物業按揭
- * **residential mortgage** = 住宅按揭
- * **mortgage portfolio** = 按揭貸款組合
- * **mortgage-backed security** = 按揭抵押證券

* **mortgage — verb** = 把物業抵押借款
 * **mortgaged property** = 已抵押物業
 * **heavily mortgaged** = 按揭負擔沉重的
 * **mortgage the future** = 透支 / 犧牲未來
 * **mortgagee** = 按揭權人 / 貸款方
 * **mortgagor** = 抵押人 / 借款方
 * **mortgage broker** = 按揭經紀
 * **mortgage insurance** = 按揭保險

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
mortgage — everyday noun	以土地 / 物業作擔保而取得、通常用於購置物業的貸款
mortgage — legal/security sense	為保障債務償還而在物業上設定的抵押擔保安排
mortgage — verb	把物業作為債務擔保以取得貸款
mortgage payment	借款人定期支付的按揭供款
mortgage balance	尚未償還的按揭貸款金額
mortgage term	按揭須在其中償還的約定期間
mortgage rate	按揭貸款所適用的利率
fixed-rate mortgage	利率在指定期間固定不變的按揭
variable-rate mortgage	利率可以隨基準 / 條款變化的按揭
mortgage affordability	家庭是否有能力持續承擔按揭供款的程度
mortgage arrears	已到期但尚未支付的按揭供款
mortgage default	借款人沒有履行按揭還款等重要義務
refinance/remortgage	以新的融資安排取代 / 重新安排原有按揭
reverse mortgage	讓合資格業主利用物業淨值取得資金的一類按揭產品
mortgagee	接受抵押擔保的一方，通常是貸款人
mortgagor	提供物業作抵押擔保的一方，通常是借款人 / 業主
mortgage-backed security	以一組按揭貸款相關現金流為基礎的金融證券
mortgage the future	為取得眼前利益而犧牲 / 預支未來的資源、自由或機會
mortgage insurance	針對指定按揭違約風險提供的保險安排

For your original sentence

> “They may care about roadside pollution, yet choose a cheaper petrol car if an electric model stretches their **mortgage budget**...”

The exact sense is:

mortgage = 用物業作擔保的住房貸款；在這句中，重點是這對年輕夫婦本身已有按揭供款負擔，因此昂貴電動車可能令整體家庭預算更吃緊。

Natural translation:

> **「他們可能關心路邊污染，但如果購買電動車會令本來已要供樓的家庭財政變得過於吃緊，他們仍可能選擇較便宜的汽油車。」**

Highest-value contrasts:

- > **mortgage** → 按揭貸款
- > **mortgage payment** → 按揭供款
- > **mortgage rate** → 按揭利率
- > **mortgage balance** → 尚欠按揭餘額
- > **mortgage term** → 按揭年期
- > **mortgage arrears** → 欠供
- > **mortgage default** → 按揭違約
- > **mortgage a house** → 把房屋抵押借款
- > **mortgagee** → 貸款 / 承按一方
- > **mortgagor** → 借款 / 抵押一方
- > **mortgage the future** → 透支 / 犧牲未來
- > **mortgage ≠ rent** → 為物業所有權融資的債務 ≠ 支付使用他人物業的租金
- > **mortgage ≠ deposit** → 借入的按揭款 ≠ 買方自己的首期
- > **mortgage ≠ house price** → 融資金額 ≠ 物業總價
- > **mortgage ≠ mortgage payment** → 貸款本身 ≠ 每期供款
- > **mortgage ≠ interest** → 債務本金 / 貸款安排 ≠ 借款成本